

MODERN CHILDREN OF ISRAEL

A Story for Thanksgiving (printed in the "Friend" November 1953)

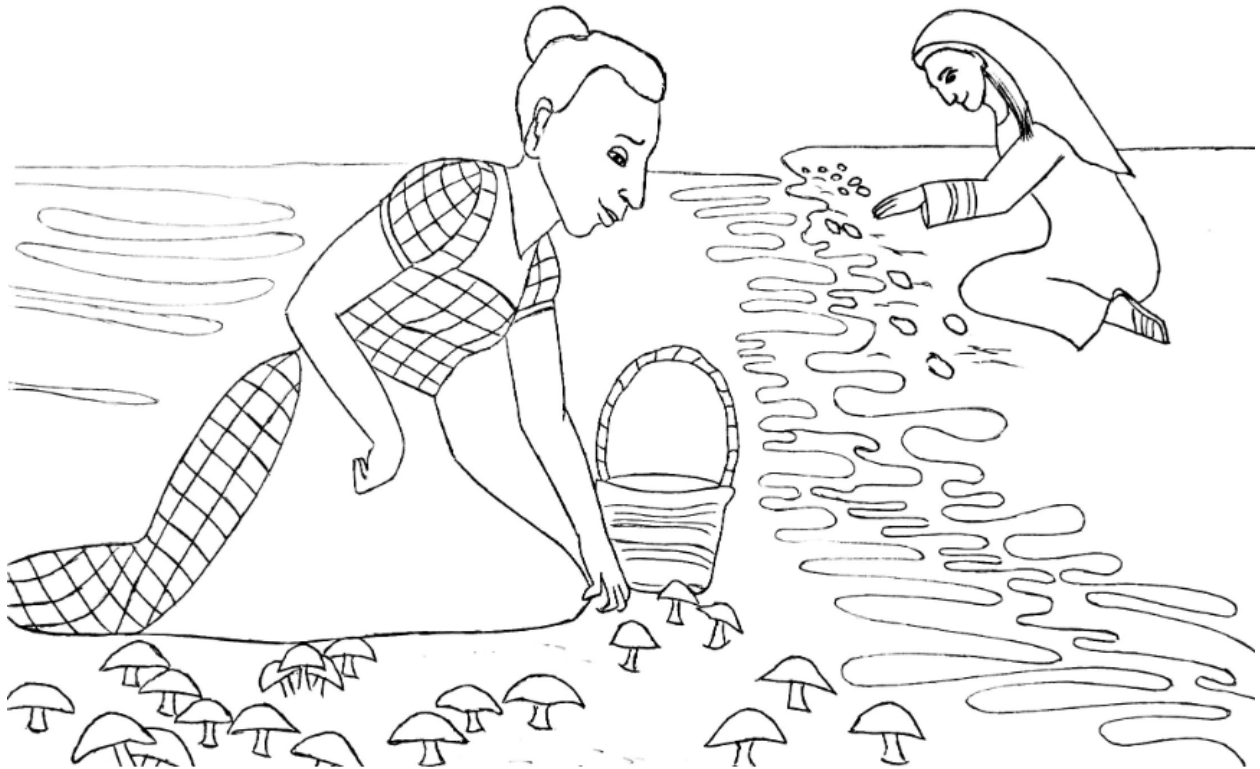
By Joel H. Martineau

Down in Mexico, in the State of Chihuahua, a little colony of Latter-day Saints- was being established. In the fall of 1892, Henry Lunt and family, of Cedar City, arrived and soon secured a piece of rich farm land along the river.





In the spring they planted it in corn. Mr. Lunt, being a good farmer, told his boys to keep it constantly hoed to keep it from drying out, for the year 1892 was a very dry year and most of the crops died for want of moisture. The boys hoed the corn; and they sweat and protested, for the task seemed hopeless. Every day the hot sun curled the corn leaves up and they did not grow very much. They barely kept alive.



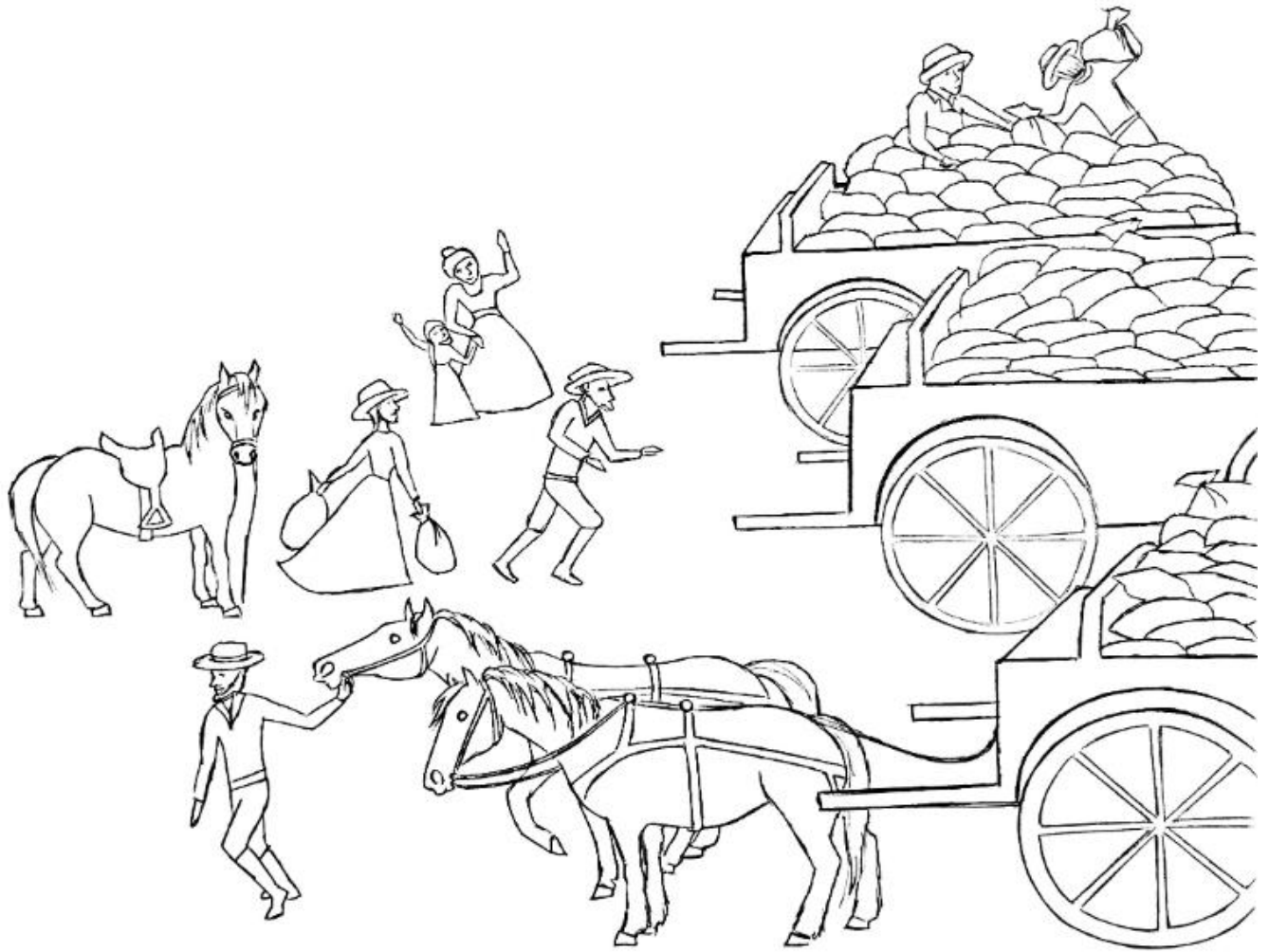
At last the rains came; the corn grew tall, and made a bumper crop. Then the boys were glad they had taken such good care of it. The people planted late gardens and when the soil was damp and the sunshine warm a great crop of mushrooms sprang up all over the town site, especially in the town square. Every morning the people gathered the mushrooms to eat. This was like the children of Israel in the wilderness, who gathered manna daily for their food.



When fall and the frosts came, the gardens and the mushrooms disappeared together. The people were destitute except for occasional wild game, which this year had gone westward to lower country on account of the drought, and was very scarce. Mr. Lunt tried to encourage the people. He gave them his corn and kept them alive until the dry spring of 1893, when he had left only enough corn for four more meals for his own family.

At this time Charles Humphrey came and offered a milk cow for enough corn to make one more meal for his family. Mr. Lunt said, "No, I will not take your cow; you need her more than I do. I will lend you corn for two meals which is one half of what I have left. Then I pray the Lord will provide for us all as he has in the past." That night Mr. Lunt's family ate one half of their supply of corn meal. After breakfast next morning there was no more corn meal in Colonia Pachecho or Corrales. Then everyone fasted and prayed.





Their prayers were answered. About the middle of the afternoon three wagons loaded with flour drove into Colonia Pacheco and Corrales, and the flour was divided among the families. The Church had provided the flour and sent it to Deming, New Mexico, and from there it was sent on with Alonzo L., Albert S., and Austin Farnsworth to Pacheco.



It is fitting to relate that before sundown Mr. Lunt had in his house more than a thousand pounds of flour which had been returned to him in place of the corn he had loaned. Mr. Lunt was a man of great faith, he knew that the Lord would provide, and he had been blessed.